

Medicare Supplement — Medigap

The Frank Agent's Guide to Selling Medigap Right

Standardized plans, guaranteed issue rights, underwriting reality, and the sales mistakes that cost U.S. Medicare agents clients — explained by someone who has seen it all.

Doc: 03 | Medicare Supplement Brief | U.S. Medicare Agents | AEP 2026 | **Brand:** AgentRisePro / 121 Urban Media LLC | **Audience:** U.S. Medicare Agents & Beneficiaries Only

■ KILL SWITCH — VERIFY BEFORE EVERY USE

- Medigap plan benefits are federally standardized under federal law (OBRA 1990, MACRA 2015). Verify current CMS standards.
- Plans C and F NOT available to beneficiaries newly eligible for Medicare on or after January 1, 2020 (MACRA). Confirm with carrier.
- Medigap OEP = 6 months from Part B effective date at age 65+. Guaranteed issue rights apply during OEP.
- Plans K and L out-of-pocket limits adjust annually. Kill Switch: verify current year at cms.gov.
- Premium rating methods vary by carrier. Always verify carrier-specific rates — never quote from memory.
- State-specific rules apply in Massachusetts, Minnesota, and Wisconsin — these states have unique Medigap structures. Verify with state DOI.

"The Medigap Open Enrollment Period is the golden window. Your client gets one clean shot at guaranteed issue coverage — no health questions, no denials, no surcharges. Miss it, and their health history becomes the insurance company's decision, not yours. Set the appointment before they turn 65. Every time."

WHAT MEDIGAP IS — AND WHAT IT IS NOT

A Medicare Supplement (Medigap) policy fills the cost-sharing gaps in Original Medicare — deductibles, coinsurance, and copayments that Parts A and B leave behind. It does NOT replace Medicare. It works alongside it. And critically: Medigap does NOT include prescription drug coverage. Every Medigap client also needs a standalone Medicare Part D plan. This is one of the most common new-agent mistakes in the field.

■ **SEASONED AGENT TIP:** Write the Part D plan at the same appointment as the Medigap plan. A Medigap client who calls six months later asking why their prescriptions aren't covered is a client who won't refer you. Don't leave without the drug plan.

U.S. STANDARDIZED MEDIGAP BENEFIT CHART (2026)

Benefit	A	B	C*	D	F*	G	K	L	M	N
Part A coinsurance + hospital	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Part B coinsurance/copay	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	50%	75%	✓	✓**
Blood (first 3 pints)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	50%	75%	✓	✓
Part A hospice coinsurance	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	50%	75%	✓	✓
Skilled nursing coinsurance	No	No	✓	✓	✓	✓	50%	75%	✓	✓
Part A deductible	No	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	50%	75%	50%	✓
Part B deductible	No	No	✓*	No	✓*	No	No	No	No	No
Part B excess charges	No	No	No	No	✓	✓	No	No	No	No
Foreign travel emergency	No	No	✓	✓	✓	✓	No	No	✓	✓

**Plans C and F: not available to those first eligible for Medicare on or after Jan 1, 2020 (MACRA 2015). **Plan N: may charge up to \$20 office visit copay; up to \$50 ER copay. Kill Switch: Plans K/L out-of-pocket limits adjust annually — verify at [cms.gov](https://www.cms.gov).*

THE MEDIGAP OPEN ENROLLMENT PERIOD — ONE SHOT, ONE WINDOW

The Medigap OEP begins the month a beneficiary is both 65 or older AND enrolled in Medicare Part B. It lasts 6 months. During this window, insurers operating in the U.S. market CANNOT deny coverage, charge more, or impose waiting periods based on health history. Pre-existing conditions are irrelevant. This is the most powerful consumer protection in Medigap — and the most time-sensitive window in your entire business calendar.

■ **FIELD WARNING:** A client who misses their Medigap OEP faces medical underwriting in most U.S. states. Carriers can deny them outright based on health history — and in most states, that denial is final. This window doesn't come around again. Schedule the appointment before they turn 65. If they're already past their OEP and have health issues, know which carriers specialize in accepting conditions others decline.

GUARANTEED ISSUE RIGHTS BEYOND THE OEP

Outside of the OEP, certain qualifying events restore Guaranteed Issue rights for U.S. beneficiaries:

- Medicare Advantage plan exits the beneficiary's service area or terminates its Medicare contract.
- Beneficiary moves out of the Medicare Advantage plan's service area.
- Medicare Advantage plan commits fraud or violates its contract with CMS.
- Beneficiary loses Medicaid (Medi-Cal, etc.) eligibility.
- Coverage ends through no fault of the beneficiary.
- Beneficiary enrolled in MA during their Medigap OEP and wants to switch back within 12 months (trial right).

THE THREE RATING METHODS — WHAT YOUR CLIENT DOESN'T KNOW

Every U.S. Medigap insurer uses one of three methods to set premiums. This is one of the most important — and least explained — concepts in the Medigap sale. Know it cold. Explain it at every appointment.

Method	How It Works	Long-Term Impact
Community-rated	Same premium for everyone in the area regardless of age	Most stable over time. Increases are market-driven, not age-driven.
Issue-age rated	Premium based on age at time of purchase; stays level as client ages	Best value if purchased early. Good long-term stability.
Attained-age rated	Premium increases as the client gets older — the most common method in the U.S.	Starts low; can become expensive by age 75-80. Many clients don't realize this.

"Never just show a client the lowest premium. Show them the rating method. An attained-age plan that looks affordable at 65 can be painful at 80. Your job is the whole picture — not just today's price."

PLAN G — THE WORKHORSE OF THE MODERN MEDIGAP MARKET

Since Plans C and F closed to new Medicare enrollees under MACRA in 2020, Plan G has become the most comprehensive option available to newly eligible U.S. beneficiaries. It covers everything Plan F covered except the Part B deductible (\$283 in 2026). High-Deductible Plan G (HDG) offers lower premiums with a higher out-of-pocket threshold before coverage kicks in — a good fit for healthier, budget-conscious clients.

■ SEASONED AGENT TIP: Always compare household discounts. Many U.S. Medigap carriers offer 5-7% discounts when two members of the same household enroll. That's money back in your client's pocket and a reason to ask: 'Is there someone else in your household I should speak with?'

VERIFIED U.S. RESOURCES & CITATIONS

CMS — Choosing a Medigap Policy (Pub 02110)

<https://www.medicare.gov/Pubs/pdf/02110-Medicare-Medigap-guide.pdf>
Official CMS Medigap guide. Keep copies. Leave one at every Medigap appointment.

Medicare.gov — Medigap Overview

<https://www.medicare.gov/supplements-other-insurance/whats-medicare-supplement-insurance-medigap>
CMS official Medigap overview and benefit comparison.

NAIC Medigap Benefit Charts

https://www.naic.org/prod_serv/MSP-ZG-16.pdf
Standardized plan comparison from the National Association of Insurance Commissioners.

Louisiana DOI

<https://www.ldi.la.gov/>
State-specific Medigap rules, agent licensing, and consumer complaint resources.

Texas DOI

<https://www.tdi.texas.gov/>
Texas-specific Medigap rules and agent licensing.

YOUR NEXT STEP: AgentRisePro

The Medicare Agent Workspace built by a 25-year U.S. Medicare field veteran — for U.S. agents who are serious about AEP.

AGENT PILOT \$38/month	AGENT PRO \$68/month	AGENCY \$83/month
Solo independent agent AEP launch special	Full features + Voice AI when live	Multi-agent teams White label ready
Script Desk Launch Kit Calendar Basic CRM	Everything in Pilot + GPT Voice (coming) + Advanced CRM + Carrier Tools	Everything in Pro + Team Dashboard + Agency Reporting + Priority Support
Annual: \$368/yr (Save \$88 — 2 mo free)	Annual: \$658/yr (Save \$158 — 2 mo free)	Annual: \$803/yr (Save \$193 — 2 mo free)

- Script Desk — Medicare scripts by product & situation
- Agent Launch Kit — all 5 briefs + 100+ questions
- Fresh Pour — agent community & audio lounge
- Training Calendar — built-in appointment by block
- Book of Business CRM — track your U.S. agents
- GPT Voice AI — hands-free in the car (coming Q1 2027)
- Download & share tools
- U.S. carrier reference library
- CMS compliance reminders built in

■ 7-DAY FREE TRIAL — NO CREDIT CARD REQUIRED

Try the full app free for 7 days. No obligation. No credit card. Cancel anytime. Pilot pricing locked in for early adopters during AEP 2026. Download the Medicare Advantage Launch Blueprint PDF for just \$4.99 — or get it FREE with your 7-day trial.

agentrisepro.com | projectagentrise.netlify.app | 121 Urban Media LLC

This guide is prepared for U.S. Medicare agents and beneficiaries only. Not for consumer distribution without agent supervision. All Medicare rules, premiums, and thresholds are subject to annual change by CMS. Kill Switch items must be verified at medicare.gov and cms.gov before each use. © 121 Urban Media LLC | AgentRisePro | All rights reserved.